INCH-POUND

MIL-R-44386(GL)
29 December 1989

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

RATION LIGHTWEIGHT, 30-DAY, ASSEMBLY OF

This specification is approved for use by the Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Department of the Army, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1. Scope. This specification covers the assembly of lightweight - 30 day rations, for use by the Department of Defense.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government Documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issue of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

A-A-20135 - Sugar
A-A-20175 - Chewing Gum
L-F-560 - Fork, Knife and Spoon, Picnic Plastic
L-P-378 - Plastic Sheet and Strip, Thin Gauge, Polyolefin

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8970

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EE-M-101 - Matches, Safety: and Matches, Nonsafety (Strike-Anywhere)
NN-P-71 - Pallet, Material and Handling, Wood, Stringer Construction, 2-Way and 4-Way (Partial)
QQ-A-1876 - Aluminum Foil
HHH-C-575 - Coffee, Instant
MMM-A-250 - Adhesive, Water-Resistant (for Closure of Fiberboard Boxes)
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

MILITARY

MIL-P-15011 - Pallet, Material Handling, Wood, Post Construction, 4-Way Entry
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification For
MIL-C-43338 - Cream Substitute, Dry, Non-Dairy
MIL-P-43988 - Paper, Toilet, Tissue (Packet in Sheet Form)
MIL-T-44284 - Tea Mix, Instant, Sweetened, Lemon Flavored (Operational Ration Component)
MIL-E-44387 - Entree Bars, Ration Lightweight, 30-Day
MIL-B-44388 - Bread Crisps, Ration Lightweight, 30-Day
MIL-C-44389 - Cereal Bars, Ration Lightweight, 30-Day
MIL-B-44390 - Beverage Bars, Ration Lightweight, 30-Day
MIL-D-44391 - Dessert Bars, Ration Lightweight, 30-Day
MIL-C-44392 - Cocoa Beverage Bar, Ration Lightweight, 30-Day
MIL-D-44393 - Dairy Bars, Ration Lightweight, 30-Day
MIL-B-44394 - Beef Snacks, Operational Ration Component

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-595 - Colors

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-731 - Quality of Wood Members for Containers and Pallets

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Naval Publications and Forms Center, (ATTN: NPODS), 5801 Tabor Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19120-5099.)

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2.1.2 Other government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES (HHS)

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

2.2 Non-Government publication. The following document forms a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

F 88 - Seal Strength of Flexible Barrier Materials

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Components and materials.

3.1.1 Meal bag.

3.1.1.1 Meal bag material. The preformed meal bag shall be fabricated, from inside to outside, of 0.003 to 0.004 inch thick polyolefin film laminated to 0.00035 to 0.00070 inch thick aluminum foil laminated to 0.0005 inch thick polyester. The material shall be suitably formulated for food use and shall not impart an odor or flavor to the product being packed. The material shall show no evidence of delamination, degradation, or foreign odor when heat sealed or fabricated into bags. Color shall be applied to either the exterior or interior

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surfaces of the polyester lamina. When applied externally, the color shall be in the range of 34079 through 34087 or shall be 10045 or 30045 through 30118 (excluding color 30109) of FED-STD-595. When applied internally, the color shall be in the range of 24052 through 24087. The color shall be applied completely and uniformly to the polyester lamina. The color application process shall not adversely affect the material performance. The material shall not transfer any foreign odor or flavor to the packaged components.

3.1.1.2 Meal bag construction. The meal bag shall be a preformed flat style bag having inside dimensions of 6-1/4 inches wide by 8-1/2 inches long (± 1/8 inch) as shown in figure 1. The first dimension is measured at the opening of the bag between the heat sealed sides. The bag shall be made by heat sealing three edges with 3/8 inch (± 1/16 inch) wide seals. The heat seals shall be made in a manner that will ensure hermetic seals. The bag shall maintain its integrity and air tightness of the side and bottom seals when tested as specified in 4.2.1.2.2. The side and bottom seals shall have an average seal strength of not less than 12 pounds per inch and no individual specimen shall have a seal strength of less than 10 pounds per inch when tested as specified in 4.2.1.2.1. A V-shaped or C-shaped (half round) tear notch at least 1/32 inch deep, located 1 to 1-1/2 inch from the top edge of the bag shall be made on one or both side seals. The distance between the inside edge of the tear notch and the inside edge of the seal shall be not less than 1/4 inch. One side of the open end of the bag shall be provided with an extended or foldover lip, extended not less than 1/8 inch to facilitate opening and filling.

3.1.2 Meal bag components. The components required for meal bag assembly shall be as specified in table I and shall be assembled into menus as specified in 3.3.

TABLE I. Menu components

Component	Document reference
Beef snacks	MIL-B-44394
Beef stew	MIL-E-44387
Chicken a la king	MIL-E-44387
Chicken with rice and ham	MIL-E-44387
Chili con carne	MIL-E-44387
Pork with rice	MIL-E-44387
Spaghetti with meat and sauce	MIL-E-44387
Cheese-bacon bread crisp	MIL-B-44388
Cheese bread crisp	MIL-B-44388
Coconut bread crisp	MIL-B-44388
Orange-nut bread crisp	MIL-B-44388
Pizza bread crisp	MIL-B-44388
Tamale bread crisp	MIL-B-44388

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TABLE I. Menu components (cont'd)

Component	Document reference
Almond dairy bar	MIL-D-44393
Maple walnut dairy bar	MIL-D-44393
Mixed nut dairy bar	MIL-D-44393
Orange creamsicle dairy bar	MIL-D-44393
Strawberry dairy bar	MIL-D-44393
Pecan dairy bar	MIL-D-44393
Apple cinnamon dessert bar	MIL-D-44391
Blueberry dessert bar	MIL-D-44391
Chocolate chip dessert bar	MIL-D-44391
Chocolate halva dessert bar	MIL-D-44391
Graham dessert bar	MIL-D-44391
Pecan dessert bar	MIL-D-44391
Bran flake cereal bar	MIL-C-44389
Corn flake cereal bar	MIL-C-44389
Malted wheat granule cereal bar	MIL-C-44389
Oat cereal biscuit bar	MIL-C-44389
Shredded wheat cereal bar	MIL-C-44389
Wheat flake cereal bar	MIL-C-44389
Lemonade beverage bar	MIL-B-44390
Lemon-lime beverage bar	MIL-B-44390
Orange beverage bar	MIL-B-44390
Raspberry beverage bar	MIL-B-44390
Strawberry beverage bar	MIL-B-44390
Tropical punch beverage bar	MIL-B-44390
Cocoa beverage bar	MIL-C-44392
Mixing bag 1/	

1/ The mixing bag shall meet the requirements of 3.1.3.

3.1.3 Mixing bag. The mixing bag shall be fabricated from 0.003 inch thick unpigmented high density 0.941 to 0.965 (g/cm^3) food grade, flat polyethylene tubing. The bottom seal shall be of adequate strength and integrity to withstand the addition of boiling water when tested in accordance with 4.2.1.4. The size of the mixing bag shall be 7 inches wide by 8-1/2 inches long (inside dimensions). The polyethylene mixing bag shall be sequentially folded in half three times so that its area is reduced to 1/8 its original size. The folded bag shall be positioned according to the configuration in figure 2.

3.1.4 Accessory bag.

3.1.4.1 Accessory bag material and construction. The accessory bag shall be fabricated from the material specified in 3.1.1.1 and constructed as specified in 3.1.1.2 except that the inside dimensions shall be 5-3/4 inches wide by 9-5/8 inches long (±1/8 inch) as shown in figure 1.

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3.1.4.2 Accessory bag components. The components required for accessory bag assembly shall be as specified in table II.

TABLE II. Accessory bag components

Component	Document reference	Quantity
Coffee, instant	HHH-C-575, type III, style A, blend (1), composition (1)	6
Cream substitute	MIL-C-43338	3
Sugar	A-A-20135, type I, class I, 6 gram envelope	3
Chewing gum	A-A-20175, type I, flavors 1 or 2	6
Matches	EE-M-101, type II, class 2	2
Toilet tissue	MIL-P-43988	6
Spoon, picnic, plastic	L-F-560, type IV, item 9	2
Closure device	1/	1
Tea mix, instant	MIL-T-44284	6

1/ The mixing bag closure device shall be fabricated from molded white nylon. The closure device shall be capable of keeping the mixing bag closed after the bag has been filled with the required amount of water, after the top of the bag has been twisted shut, and during the time required for rehydration of the product (see 6.2).

3.2 Accessory bag assembly. The specified number of components indicated in table II shall be inserted in an accessory bag as specified in 3.1.4.1 according to the configuration in figures 3A and 3B. Prior to insertion, the components may be shrink wrapped to facilitate assembly. The filled bag shall then be hermetically sealed, by evacuating the air within a sealing chamber under a vacuum between 26 and 28 inches of mercury, and applying a continuous heat seal of not less than 1/8 inch wide. The closure seal shall be free of foldover wrinkles, delamination, occluded matter, and entrapped moisture or grease. The closure seal shall not extend below the tear notch. The average closure seal strength shall not be less than 12 pounds per inch and no individual test specimen shall be less than 10 pounds per inch when tested as specified in 4.2.3.4. With corner tabs folded flat, the volume of the filled and sealed bag shall not exceed 45 cubic inches. The filled and sealed accessory bag shall show no loss of vacuum when examined as specified in 4.2.3.3.

3.3 Menu assembly. One each of the applicable menu components indicated in table III shall be inserted into the meal bag specified in 3.1.1. The components shall be arranged in accordance with the configuration in figure 2. Prior to insertion the components may be shrink wrapped to facilitate assembly. The filled bag shall then be hermetically sealed, by evacuating the air within a

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sealing chamber under a vacuum between 26 and 28 inches of mercury, and applying a continuous heat seal of not less than 1/8 inch wide. The closure seal shall be free of fold over wrinkles, delamination, occluded matter and entrapped moisture or grease. The closure seal shall not extend below the tear notch. The average closure seal strength shall not be less than 12 pounds per inch and no individual test specimen shall be less than 10 pounds per inch when tested as specified in 4.2.2.4. With corner tabs folded flat, the volume of the filled and sealed bag shall not exceed 45 cubic inches. The filled and sealed bag shall show no loss of vacuum when examined as specified in 4.2.2.3.

TABLE III. Menu contents

Menu No., Components therein	Menu No., Components therein
Menu #1	Menu #2
Chicken a la king	Beef stew
Cheese bread crisp	Tamale bread crisp
Almond dairy bar	Strawberry dairy bar
Blueberry dessert bar	Chocolate chip dessert bar
Shredded wheat cereal bar	Wheat flake cereal bar
Tropical punch beverage bar	Lemonade beverage bar
Cocoa beverage bar	Cocoa beverage bar
Beef snacks	Beef snacks
Mixing bag	Mixing bag
Menu #3	Menu #4
Pork with rice	Chicken with rice and ham
Pizza bread crisp	Cheese-bacon bread crisp
Pecan dairy bar	Orange creamsicle dairy bar
Apple cinnamon dessert bar	Pecan dessert bar
Bran flake cereal bar	Oat cereal biscuit bar
Orange beverage bar	Lemon-lime beverage bar
Cocoa beverage bar	Cocoa beverage bar
Beef snacks	Beef snacks
Mixing bag	Mixing bag
Menu #5	Menu #6
Spaghetti with meat and sauce	Chili con carne
Coconut bread crisp	Orange-nut bread crisp
Mixed nut dairy bar	Maple walnut dairy bar
Chocolate halva dessert bar	Graham dessert bar
Malted wheat granules cereal bar	Corn flakes cereal bar
Strawberry beverage bar	Raspberry beverage bar
Cocoa beverage bar	Cocoa beverage bar
Beef snacks	Beef snacks
Mixing bag	Mixing bag

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3.4 Meal box and accessory box assembly. One filled and sealed meal bag and one filled and sealed accessory bag shall each be separately overpacked and cushioned, if necessary, in a snug fitting paperboard box as specified in 3.4.1.

3.4.1 Paperboard boxes. Folding paperboard boxes used to overpack meal and accessory bags shall be constructed of nominal 0.026 inch thick unbleached and uncoated, full bending chipboard in accordance with variety 1, style I, type A, class a of PPP-B-566. The band of adhesive between inner and outer flaps of the box must be continuous. There shall be no unglued area exceeding 1/2 inch from the end on either end of the flaps. The paperboard boxes shall be sealed closed with hot melt adhesive. Bond strength of the dried adhesive in box closure shall be greater than the fiber strength of the paperboard box. The dimensions of the paperboard boxes shall be 3-1/2 inches in length, 2-3/4 inches in width, and 5-1/4 inches in depth (± 1/16) as shown in figure 4.

3.5 Labeling.

3.5.1 Meal bag and meal box (paperboard) labeling. Each meal bag and each meal box shall be labeled or marked on one main panel in a permanent contrasting manner in characters not less than 1/8 inch high, as follows:

RATION, LIGHTWEIGHT - 30 DAY
Menu No. (1 through 6, as applicable)
Name and address of assembler and date (Julian date) 1/

1/ The lot number shall be expressed as a four digit Julian code. The first digit shall indicate the year of production and the next three digits shall indicate the day of the year (Example, March 19, 1987 would be coded as 7078). The Julian code shall represent the day the product was packaged. Sub-lotting (when used) shall be represented by an alpha character immediately following the four digit Julian code.

3.5.2 Accessory bag and accessory box (paperboard) labeling. Each accessory bag and each accessory box shall be labeled or marked in the manner prescribed in 3.5.1 and with the following:

6 DAY ACCESSORY PACK
RLW-30 DAY
CONTENTS: List of accessory packet components shown in table II

3.6 Plant qualification. The product shall be prepared, processed and packaged in establishments meeting the requirements of Title 21, Code of Federal Regulations, Part 110, "Current Good Manufacturing Practice in Manufacturing, Processing, and Packaging or Holding of Human Foods", and the plant sanitation requirements of the appropriate Government inspection agency.

3.7 Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements (examinations and tests) as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to ensure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.2.1.1 Material certification. Material listed below may be accepted on the basis of a contractor's certificate of conformance to the indicated requirements.

Requirement	Requirement paragraph	Test procedure
Meal bag and accessory bag material:		
Identification	3.1.1.1	Laboratory evaluation
Polyolefin and polyester film thickness	3.1.1.1	As specified in L-P-378, except that a machinist's micrometer may be used provided that its graduations and accuracy conform to the requirements of L-P-378
Aluminum foil thickness	3.1.1.1	As specified in QQ-A-1876
Color	3.1.1.1	Visual evaluation

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by employees

Folding Paperboard box:

Material variety, style, type, and class	3.4.1	As specified in PPP-B-566
Material thickness	3.4.1	A machinist's micrometer may be used to determine thickness

4.2.1.2 Unfilled bag certification. A certificate of compliance may be accepted as evidence that unfilled bags conform to requirements specified in 3.1.1.1 and 3.1.4.1. When deemed necessary by the USDA, testing of the unfilled preformed bags for seal strength and integrity and air tightness of manufacturer's seals shall be as specified in 4.2.1.2.1 and 4.2.1.2.2.

4.2.1.2.1 Unfilled preformed bag seal strength testing. The unfilled preformed bags shall be tested for seal strength in accordance with ASTM F 88, except that the specimen holding clamps shall be spaced 2 inches apart prior to testing and the testing speed shall be 10 or 12 inches per minute. Machines that apply the tensile load to the test specimen by movement of the upper or lower clamp may be used. Test specimens shall be cut 1/2 or 1 inch wide and to a length suitable for proper mounting. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one unfilled, preformed bag. The sample size shall be the number of bags indicated by inspection level S-1. Three adjacent specimens shall be cut from each of the three sealed sides of each bag in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 pound per inch of width. The average seal strength of each seal shall be calculated by averaging the strengths of the three test specimens cut from that seal. Any test specimen failing to meet the individual test specimen seal strength requirement or any seal failing to meet the average seal strength requirements specified in 3.1.1.2 shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.2.1.2.2 Unfilled preformed bag integrity and air tightness of manufacturer's seals testing. Bag integrity and air tightness of seals shall be determined by placing rigid material, approximately 45 cubic inches, into the bag and sealing under a vacuum of not less than 25 inches of mercury. Not less than 96 hours after vacuum sealing, the bag shall be examined for vacuum loss in accordance with the procedure in 4.2.2.3 and 4.2.3.3 as applicable. Any evidence of loss of vacuum shall be classified as a major defect. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one unfilled bag. The inspection level shall be I and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 0.65.

4.2.1.3 Unfilled mixing bag examination. The unfilled mixing bags shall be examined for the defects listed in table IV. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one unfilled mixing bag. The inspection level shall be S-4 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 0.65.

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TABLE IV. Unfilled mixing bag defects

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Not formed as specified
102	Inside dimensions not as specified
103	Tear, hole, or open seal
104	Not material specified
105	Bags stick together
106	Not clean 1/
107	Bag has foreign odor

1/ Outer packaging shall be free from foreign matter which is unwholesome, has the potential to cause bag damage (for example, glass, metal filings, etc.) or generally detracts from the clean appearance of the bag. The following examples shall not be scored as defects for unclean:

a. Foreign matter which presents no health hazard or potential bag damage and which can readily be removed by gently shaking the bag or by gently brushing the bag with a clean dry cloth.

b. Dried product which affects less than 1/8 of the total surface area of one bag face (localized and aggregate).

c. Water spots.

4.2.1.4 Unfilled mixing bag leakage testing. The unfilled mixing bag shall be tested for leakage as follows: Each sample bag shall be filled with 8 ounces of boiling water (being careful not to spill any water on the outside) and suspended 8 to 12 inches above a sheet of clean paper for 10 minutes. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one bag. The inspection level shall be S-1. Any moisture on the paper attributable to bag leakage shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.2.2 Meal bag inspection.

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4.2.2.1 Filled and sealed meal bag examination. The filled and sealed meal bags shall be examined for the defects listed in table V. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed meal bag. The inspection level shall be S-4 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5 for major defects and 4.0 for minor defects.

TABLE V. Filled and sealed meal bag defects 1/

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Bag size not as specified 2/
102		Not heat sealed as specified
103		Tear, hole, or open seal
104		Evidence of delamination 3/
105		Bag has foreign odor
106		Contents caught in closure seal
107		Color not as specified
108		Assembler's seal (closure seal) extends into or below tear notch
109		Crushed (adversely affecting contents)
110		Labeling missing, incorrect, illegible or that smudges
111		Not clean 4/
112		Seal widths not as specified

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TABLE V. Filled and sealed meal bag defects 1/ (cont'd)

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
113		Presence of foldover wrinkles, occluded matter, grease, or entrapped matter that reduces the effective closure seal to less than 1/8 inch 5/
	201	Tear notch missing
	202	Tear notch not located as specified
	203	Depth of tear notch not as specified

1/ Examination of meal bags shall be made after shipping container is filled, closed, sleeved, and reinforced.

2/ Measurement may be accomplished on unfilled bags being used for current production lot.

3/ Delamination shall be scored as a defect except delamination of outer ply when located in the seal area 1/16 inch or further from food product edge of seal. Bags exhibiting this type of delamination shall be tested by manually flexing the delaminated area 10 times. The area of delamination shall be held between thumb and forefinger of each hand with both thumbs and forefingers touching each other. The delamination area shall then be rapidly flexed by rotating both hands in alternating clockwise-counterclockwise directions. Care shall be exercised when flexing delaminated area near the tear notches to avoid tearing the bag material. After flexing, the separated outer ply shall be grasped between thumb and forefinger and gently lifted toward the food product edge of the seal. If the separated area is too small to be held between the thumb and forefinger, a number two stylus shall be inserted into the delaminated area and gentle lifting force applied against the outer ply. If separation of the outer ply can be made to extend less than 1/16 inch from the product edge of the seal with no discernible resistence to the gentle lifting, it shall be considered evidence of delamination.

4/ Outer packaging shall be free from foreign matter which is unwholesome, has the potential to cause bag damage (for example, glass, metal filings, etc.) or generally detracts from the clean appearance of the bag. The following examples shall not be scored as defects for unclean:

a. Foreign matter which presents no health hazard or potential bag damage and which can readily be removed by gently shaking the bag or by gently brushing the bag with a clean dry cloth.

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b. Dried product which affects less than 1/8 of the total surface area of one bag face (localized and aggregate).

c. Water spots.

5/ The effective closure seal is defined as any uncontaminated, fusion bonded, continuous path, minimum 1/8 inch wide from side seal to side seal that produces a hermetically sealed bag.

4.2.2.2 Meal bag contents examination. The filled and sealed meal bags shall be examined for the defects listed in table VI. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one filled meal bag, open or sealed. The inspection level shall be S-4 and the AQL, expressed in term of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5 for major defects and 4.0 for minor defects.

TABLE VI. Meal bag contents defects

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Missing component (each missing component shall be a defect)
102		Component not clean (such as, but not limited to stain, smear, or any other foreign matter) 1/
103		Tear hole or open seam in any of the components
104		Incorrect assortment for menu package
105		Loss of vacuum in any component
106		Foreign odor
107		Components not arranged as specified
	201	Broken or crumbled bar (more than three pieces) 2/
	202	More than the required number of components (each item in excess of requirement shall be scored as a defect)

1/ Outer packaging shall be free from foreign matter which is unwholesome, has the potential to cause bag damage (for example, glass, metal filings, etc.) or generally detracts from the clean appearance of the bag. The following examples shall not be scored as defects for unclean:

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a. Foreign matter which presents no health hazard or potential bag damage and which can readily be removed by gently shaking the bag or by gently brushing the bag with a clean dry cloth.

b. Dried product which affects less than 1/8 of the total surface area of one pouch face (localized and aggregate).

c. Water spots.

2/ A broken or crumbled bar is a bar which either:

a. Has been broken into more than three pieces, the smallest of which is larger than 1/2 cubic inch in volume, or

b. Has more than 1/8 of the volume of the bar crushed.

4.2.2.3 Meal bag vacuum examination. Not less than 96 hours after filling and sealing, the meal bags shall be visually examined for conformance to the vacuum requirements in 3.3. The sealed bags shall continue to exhibit tight adherence to the surface contours of the contents when a pulling force is applied at the center of each side seal. This force shall be applied by holding each side seal between thumb and forefinger of each hand, while simultaneously exerting a slight pull with both hands. Any evidence of loss of vacuum shall be classified as a major defect. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed meal bag. The inspection level shall be I and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 0.65.

4.2.2.4 Meal bag closure seal strength examination. The filled and sealed meal bag shall be tested for closure seal strength in accordance with ASTM F 88, except that the specimen holding clamps shall be spaced 2 inches apart prior to testing and the testing speed may be 10 or 12 inches per minute. Machines that apply the tensile load to the test specimen by movement of the upper or lower clamp may be used. Test specimens shall be cut 1/2 inch in width and to a length suitable for proper mounting. Three adjacent specimens shall be cut from the closure seal of each bag in the sample. The average seal strength of the closure seal shall be calculated by averaging the test results of the three test specimens cut from that seal. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 pound per inch of width. Any test specimen or average seal strength failing to meet the requirements of 3.3 shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed bag. The inspection level shall be S-1.

4.2.3 Accessory bag inspection.

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as used to receive, inspect, process, or store components and area

4.2.3.1 Filled and sealed accessory bag examination. The filled and sealed accessory bags shall be examined for the defects listed in table VII. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed accessory bag. The inspection level shall be S-4 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5 for major defects and 4.0 for minor defects.

TABLE VII. Filled and sealed accessory bag defects 1/

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Bag size not as specified 2/
102		Not heat sealed as specified
103		Tear, hole, or open seal
104		Evidence of delamination 3/
105		Bag has foreign odor
106		Contents caught in closure seal
107		Color not as specified
108		Assembler's seal (closure seal) extends into or below tear notch
109		Crushed (adversely affecting contents)
110		Labeling missing, incorrect, illegible or that smudges
111		Not clean 4/
112		Seal widths not as specified
113		Presence of foldover wrinkles, occluded matter, grease, or entrapped matter that reduces the effective closure seal to less than 1/8 inch 5/

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TABLE VII. Filled and sealed accessory bag defects 1/ (cont'd)

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
	201	Tear notch missing
	202	Tear notch not located as specified
	203	Depth of tear notch not as specified

1/ Examination of accessory bags shall be made after shipping container is filled, closed, sleeved, and reinforced.

2/ Measurement may be accomplished on unfilled bags being used for current production lot.

3/ Delamination shall be scored as a defect except delamination of outer ply when located in the seal area 1/16 inch or further from food product edge of seal. Bags exhibiting this type of delamination shall be tested by manually flexing the delaminated area 10 times. The area of delamination shall be held between thumb and forefinger of each hand with both thumbs and forefingers touching each other. The delamination area shall then be rapidly flexed by rotating both hands in alternating clockwise-counterclockwise directions. Care shall be exercised when flexing delaminated area near the tear notches to avoid tearing the bag material. After flexing, the separated outer ply shall be grasped between thumb and forefinger and gently lifted toward the food product edge of the seal. If the separated area is too small to be held between the thumb and forefinger, a number two stylus shall be inserted into the delaminated area and gentle lifting force applied against the outer ply. If separation of the outer ply can be made to extend less than 1/16 inch from the product edge of the seal with no discernible resistence to the gentle lifting, it shall be considered evidence of delamination.

4/ Outer packaging shall be free from foreign matter which is unwholesome, has the potential to cause bag damage (for example, glass metal filings, etc.) or generally detracts from the clean appearance of the bag. The following examples shall not be scored as defects for unclean:

a. Foreign matter which presents no health hazard or potential bag damage and which can readily be removed by gently shaking the bag or by gently brushing the bag with a clean dry cloth.

b. Dried product which affects less than 1/8 of the total surface area of one bag face (localized and aggregate).

c. Water spots.

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5/ The effective closure seal is defined as any uncontaminated, fusion bonded, continuous path, minimum 1/8 inch wide from side seal to side seal that produces a hermetically sealed bag.

4.2.3.2 Accessory bag contents examination. The filled and sealed accessory bags shall be examined for the defects listed in table VIII. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed accessory bag. The inspection level shall be S-4 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5 for major defects and 4.0 for minor defects.

TABLE VIII. Accessory bag contents defects

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Missing component (each missing component shall be a defect)
102		Component not clean (such as, but not limited to stain, smear, or any other foreign matter) 1/
103		Tear, hole, or open seam in any of the components
104		Both spoons broken
105		One or both spoons broken
106		Components not arranged as specified
	201	Toilet paper not secured by paper band
	202	More than required number of components (each item in excess of requirement shall be scored as a defect)
	203	Chewing gum crushed, limiting serviceability (chewing gum may be broken but not crumbled)

1/ Outer packaging shall be free from foreign matter which is unwholesome, has the potential to cause bag damage (for example, glass, metal filings, etc.) or generally detracts from the clean appearance of the bag. The following examples shall not be scored as defects for unclean:

a. Foreign matter which presents no health hazard or potential bag damage and which can readily be removed by gently shaking the bag or by gently brushing the bag with a clean dry cloth.

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b. Dried product which affects less than 1/8 of the total surface area of one bag face (localized and aggregate).

c. Water spots.

4.2.3.3 Accessory bag vacuum examination. The filled and sealed accessory bags shall be visually examined for conformance to the vacuum requirements in 3.2 in accordance with the procedure specified in 4.2.2.3. Any evidence of loss of vacuum shall be classified as a major defect. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed accessory bag. The inspection level shall be I and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 0.65.

4.2.3.4 Accessory bag closure seal strength examination. The filled and sealed accessory bag shall be tested for closure seal strength in accordance with the procedure specified in 4.2.2.4. Any test specimen or average seal strength failing to meet the requirements of 3.2 shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed accessory bag. The inspection level shall be S-1.

4.2.4 Examination of paperboard boxes.

4.2.4.1 Meal paperboard box examination. Filled and sealed paperboard meal boxes shall be examined for defects in accordance with table IX. The lot size shall be expressed in units of filled and sealed meal boxes. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed box. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 0.65 for major defects and 2.5 for minor defects. Evidence of insect or rodent infestation found during any of the examinations shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

TABLE IX. Paperboard box defects

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Box material not as specified
102		Not thickness specified
103		Band of adhesive between inner and outer flaps of box is not continuous or either end of the flaps has an unglued area exceeding 1/2 inch from the end
104		Bond strength of dried adhesive in box closure is not greater than fiber strength of paperboard box
105		Box labeling is missing, incorrect, or illegible

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TABLE IX. Paperboard box defects (cont'd)

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
106		Box not specified dimensions
107		Crushed or torn box (over 1/2 inch long)
108		Adhesive smears in places other than at closure (not to be duplicate scored under 202)
109		Misshaped box (bulged)
	201	Box torn (not over 1/2 inch long)
	202	Box not clean 1/

1/ The following examples shall not be scored as defects for unclean:

a. Water spots.

b. Two or less specks of dried product each of which measure 1/8 inch by 1/8 inch or equivalent area, or less.

c. Any foreign matter which presents no health hazard or no potential box damage and which readily falls off when box is lifted and shaken lightly.

4.2.4.2 Examination of accessory paperboard boxes. Filled and sealed paperboard accessory boxes shall be examined for defects in accordance with table IX. The lot size shall be expressed in units of filled and sealed accessory boxes. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed box. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 0.65 for major defects and 2.5 for minor defects. Evidence of insect or rodent infestation found during any of the examinations shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.2.5 Component inspection. When the assembler vacuum seals menu components into unit pouches, the assembler shall be responsible for meeting the applicable quality assurance provisions of the individual component documents listed below.

MIL-E-44387 - Entree Bars, Ration Lightweight, 30-Day
MIL-B-44388 - Bread Crisps, Ration Lightweight, 30-Day
MIL-C-44389 - Cereal Bars, Ration Lightweight, 30-Day
MIL-B-44390 - Beverage Bars, Ration Lightweight, 30-Day
MIL-D-44391 - Dessert Bars, Ration Lightweight, 30-Day
MIL-C-44392 - Cocoa Beverage Bar, Ration Lightweight, 30-Day
MIL-D-44393 - Dairy Bars, Ration Lightweight, 30-Day

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4.2.6 Shipping container inspection.

4.2.6.1 Shipping container examination. Examination of the filled and closed shipping containers shall be in accordance with the examination criteria of the appendix of PPP-B-636 except that the closure examination shall be in accordance with 4.2.6.2. In addition, the following defects shall be included in the table of examination:

Major: National stock number, item description, contract number or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Metal fasteners used in closing the box.
Outer flaps do not completely meet, leaving an opening greater than 1/2 inch between flap ends.

Minor: Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.

4.2.6.2 Flap closure testing. The closure of the four outer flaps of the container shall be tested separately. A 90 degree angular bar with each leg approximately 5 inches long by 3 inches wide by 1/8 inch thick shall be used to test the flap closures. Insert one leg of the angular bar full length under the center of one outer flap. Insertion shall be made through the open slot between the outer flaps. Lift the container vertically by the other leg of the bar until the container is suspended. The complete upper surface of the inserted leg shall be in contact with the inner surface of the flap during the lifting and suspension of the container. Complete separation of the adhesive bond of one or more of the outer flaps shall be classified as a major defect. The lot size shall be expressed in shipping containers. The sample unit shall be one shipping container. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0.

4.2.6.3 Shipping container interior examination. The filled and sealed shipping containers shall be examined for defects listed in table X. The lot size shall be expressed in shipping containers. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed shipping container. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

TABLE X. Shipping container interior defects

Category	Defect
Major	
101	More or less than 30 menu boxes
102	Not five of each menu
103	More or less than five accessory boxes

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TABLE X. Shipping container interior defects (cont'd)

Category	Defect
Major	
104	Contents loose (not snug fitting)
105	Not packed or arranged as specified
106	Box liner missing
107	Liner not material specified
108	Height of box liner less than inside depth dimension of box by more than 1/8 inch or extends above top edge of box

4.2.6.4 Examination of adhered sleeve glued joint. The sleeve glued joint shall be examined in accordance with the glue closure examination requirements for the weather resistant boxes as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

4.2.7 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packing. Thirty menu boxes, five of each menu of table III, and five accessory boxes shall be packed in a snug fitting fiberboard box according to the configuration in figure 5, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L-SL, grade V2s of PPP-B-636, except metal fasteners shall not be used in the closure of the flaps, the gap between either flaps shall not be more than 1/2 inch wide, and adequacy of the closure shall be determined by testing as specified in 4.2.6.2. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to grade V3c of PPP-B-636. The outside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a sleeve conforming to grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+ 0 inch, - 1/8 inch). Inner flaps of the box may be closed with two strips of hot melt adhesive per flap, provided the closure meets the test requirements of 4.2.6.2. As an alternative to body joint metal fasteners, adhesive conforming to MMM-A-250, applied in accordance with the "adhesive joint" requirement of PPP-B-636, may be used to secure the manufacturer's joint of the V2s box. As an alternative to sleeve joint metal fasteners, adhesive conforming to MMM-A-250 may be used for securing the joint, except the overlap shall be a minimum of 3 inches wide. The adhesive sleeve joint shall cover a minimum of 90 percent of the sleeve overlap area. Fiberboard boxes shall be reinforced in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636, except pressure-sensitive adhesive filament reinforced tape shall not be used and boxes shall be

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reinforced with two girthwise straps positioned to divide the box into units of equal length. The inside dimensions of the fiberboard box shall be 15 inches in length, 13-1/8 inches in width, and 11 inches in depth.

5.2 Unit Loads. Twenty-seven fiberboard boxes, closed as specified in 5.1, shall be palletized in accordance with figure 6 on a 4-way entry pallet conforming to NN-P-71 or MIL-P-15011. The pallet shall be fabricated from wood groups I or II of MIL-STD-731. The fiberboard boxes shall be arranged so that the markings of at least one side of each box are visible. Fiberboard boxes shall be secured under the top deck of the pallet base by means of a 0.006 inch thick polyethylene shrink wrap, in accordance with L-P-378, type IV, class 3, grade A, finish 1. Dimensions of the unit load shall be 45 inches by 47 inches by approximately 38 inches in depth. Alternatively, 0.0025 inch thick polyvinyl chloride shall be acceptable. When intended for Navy use, the unit load shall not be shrink wrapped.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Shipping containers. Shipping containers for the Ration Lightweight, 30-Day shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 and as specified in the contract with the following exceptions:

a. Identification markings normally placed on an end of the shipping container shall be placed on the corresponding end of the sleeve. Contract data and other required markings will be placed on the side of the shipping container to the right of the marked end of the sleeve (when sleeve is positioned on the shipping container).

b. The top of the sleeve shall be marked "RATION, LIGHTWEIGHT - 30 DAY" in letters not less than 1-1/4 inches high.

c. The bottom end of the sleeve as well as the bottom of the case shall convey the box maker's compliance markings as required.

5.3.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078 and as specified in the contract.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).

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6.2 Closure device. The mixing bag closure device may be the Dennison "Flip-Clip" or equivalent. The Flip-Clip Fastener is manufactured by the Dennison Manufacturing Company, Framingham, MA 01701.

6.4 Subject term (key word) listing.

Accessory packet
Combat field feeding
Food processing
Meal bag
Menu
Operational ration

Custodians:

Army - GL

Review activities:

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC, SA
Air Force - 50
DP - SS

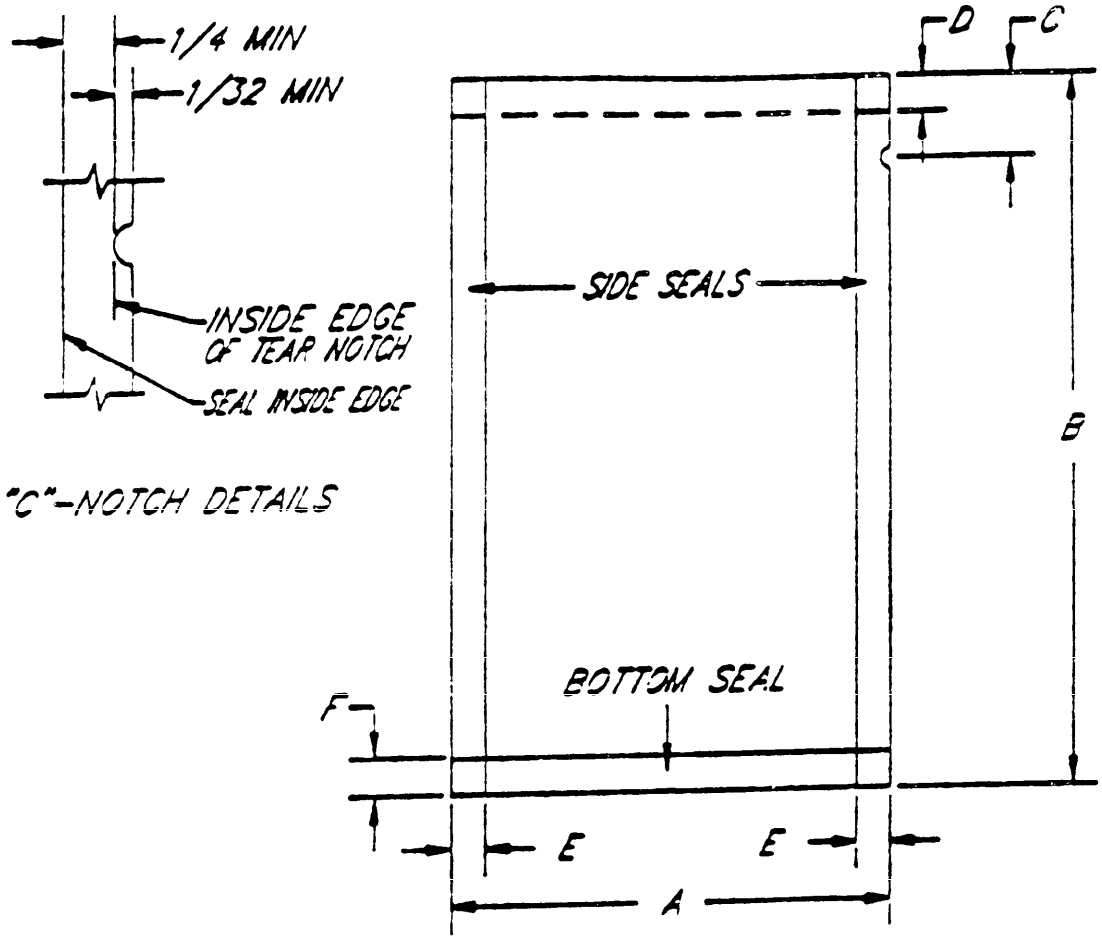
Preparing activity:

Army - GL

(Project 8970-A147)

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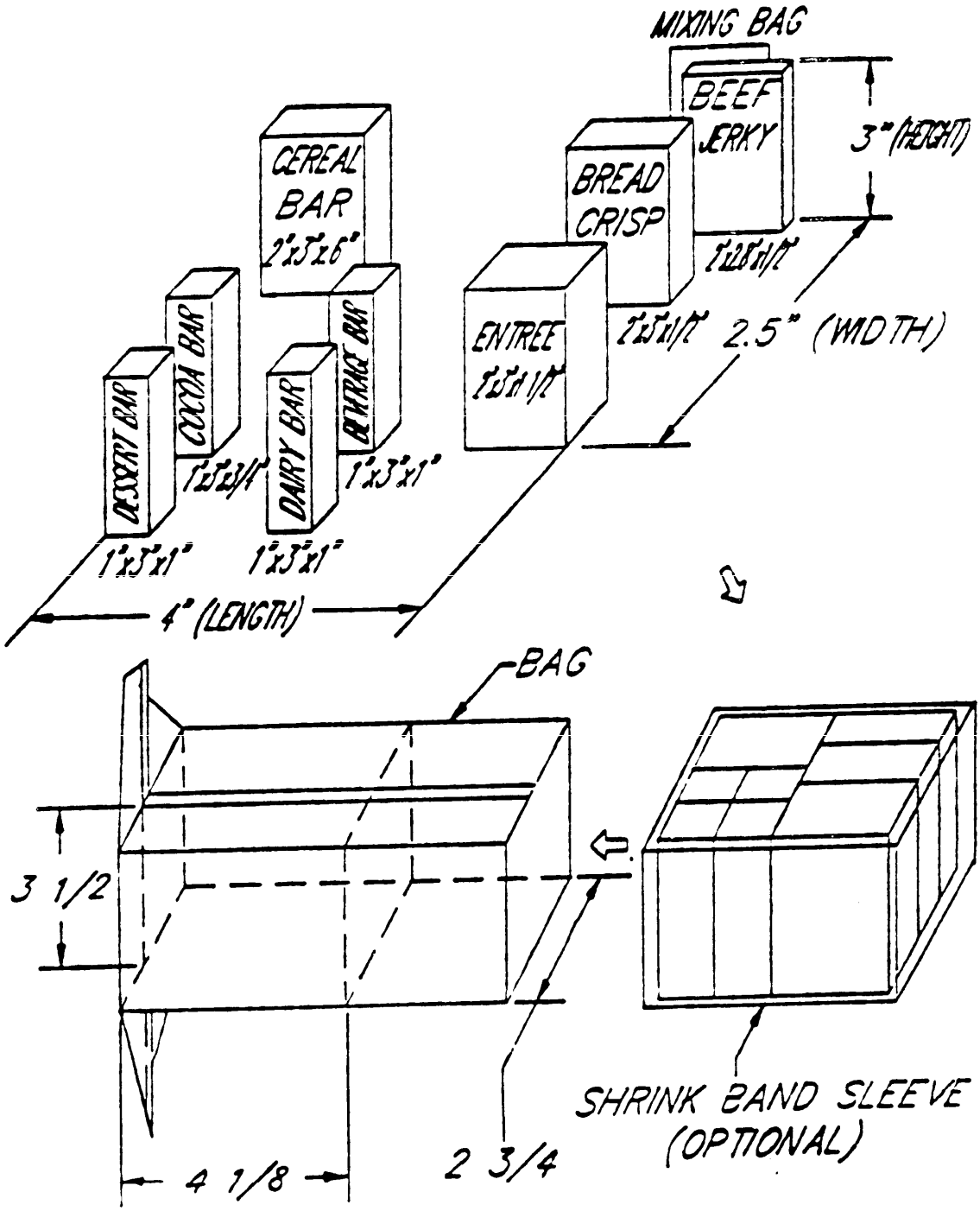
FIGURE 1. BAG CONSTRUCTION



TYPE OF BAG	DIMENSIONS, INCHES					
	A	B	C	D	E	F
MEAL BAG	7 (±1/8)	9 1/8 (±1/8)	1 TO 1 1/2	1/8 MIN	3/2 (±1/16)	3/8 (±1/16)
ACCESSORY BAG	6 1/2 (±1/8)	10 (±1/8)	1 TO 1 1/2	1/8 MIN	3/8 (±1/16)	3/8 (±1/16)

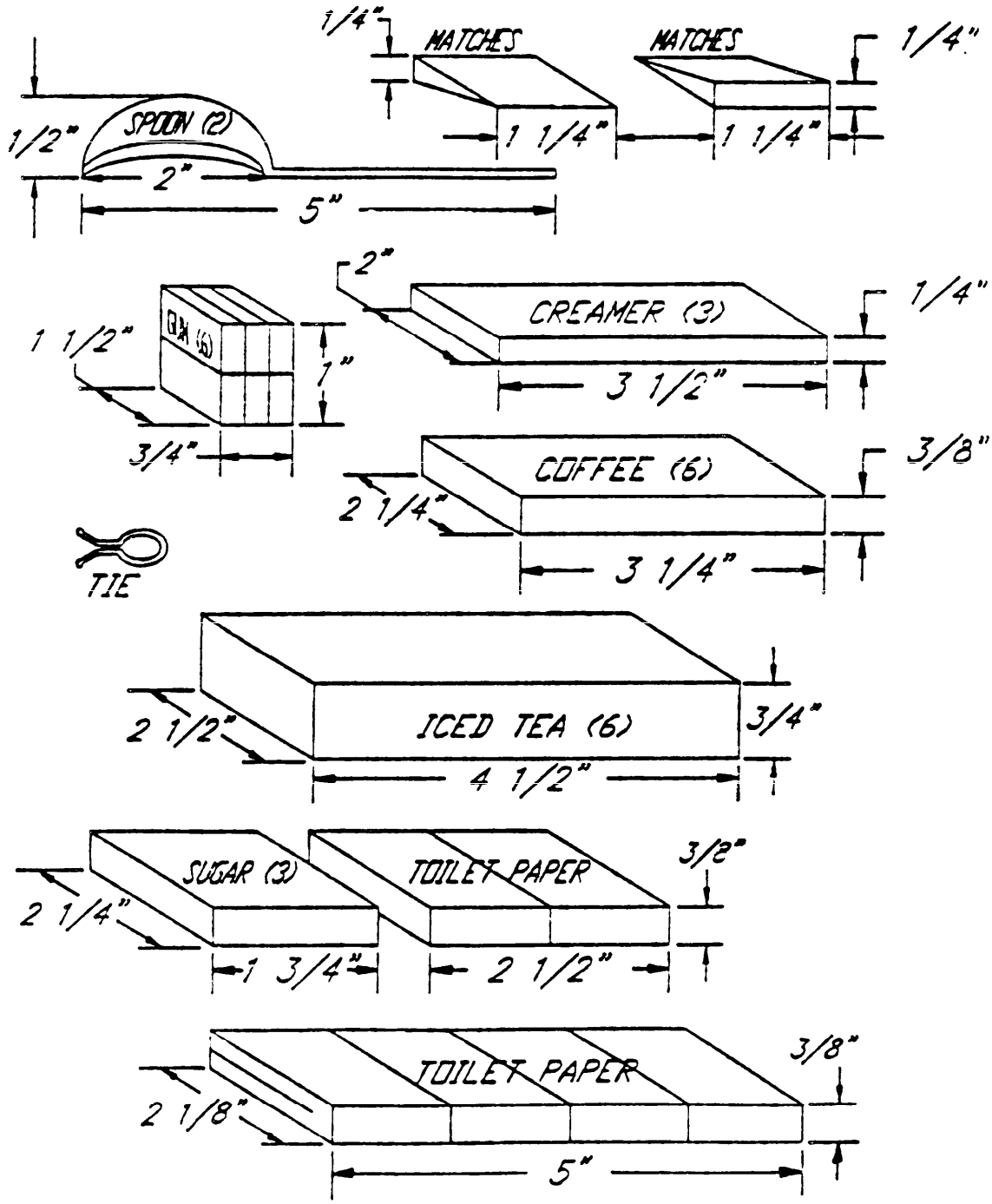
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FIGURE 2. MEAL BAG ASSEMBLY (DIMENSIONS APPROXIMATE)



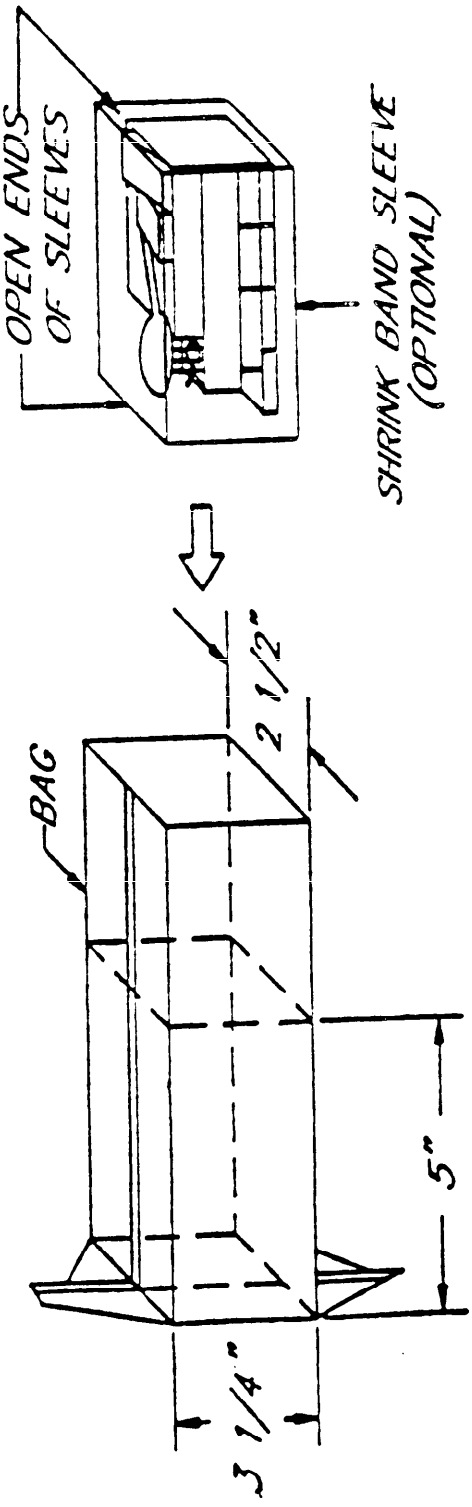
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FIGURE 3A. ACCESSORY PACK ASSEMBLY (APPROXIMATE DIMENSIONS)



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FIGURE 3B. ACCESSORY PACK ASSEMBLY (DIMENSIONS APPROXIMATE)



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FIGURE 4. PAPERBOARD BOX

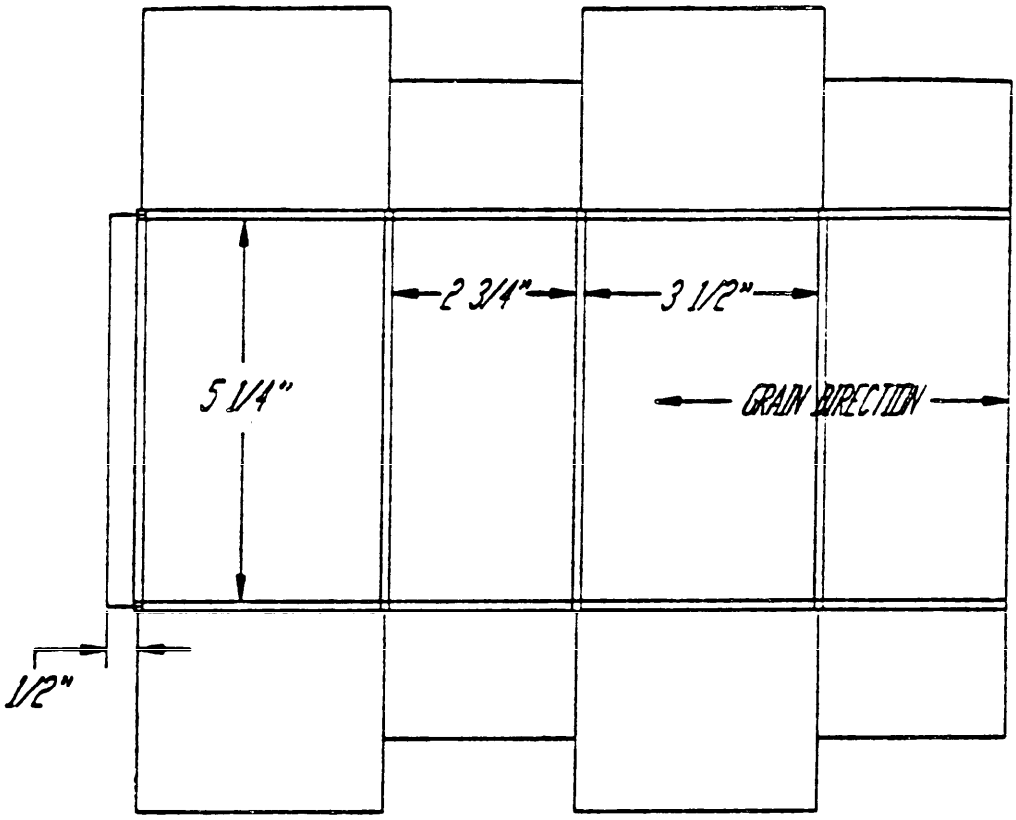
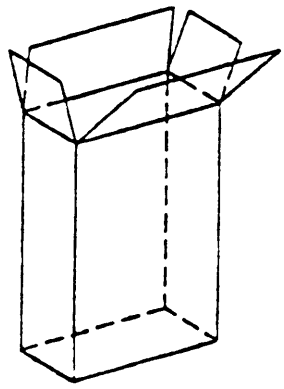


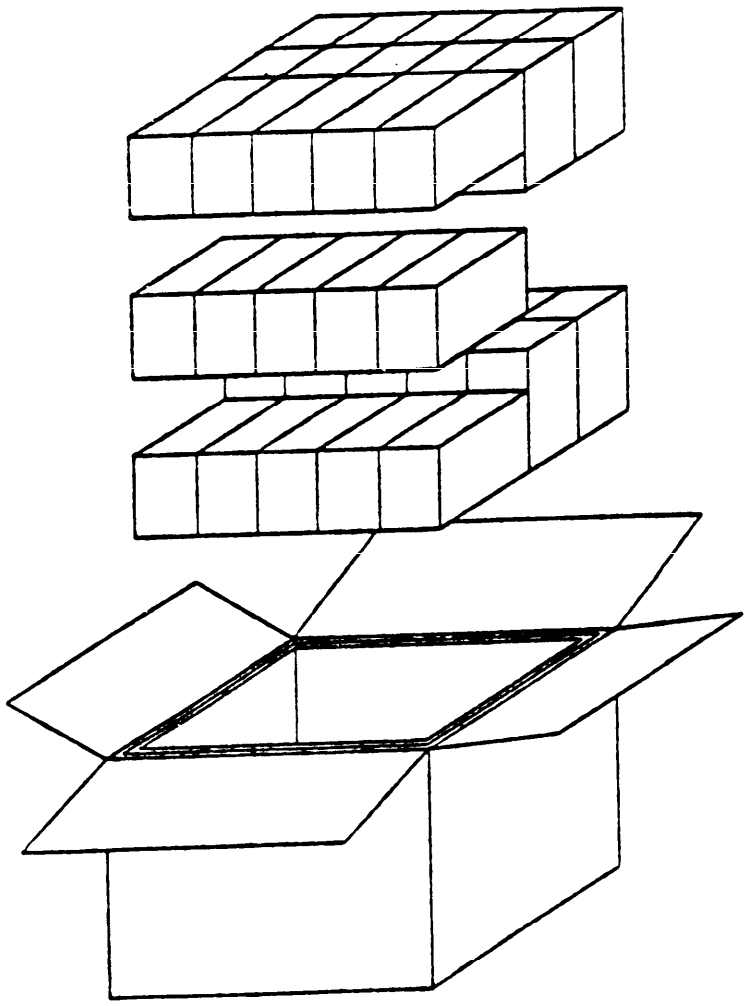
DIAGRAM SHOWING THE OUTSIDE OF THE BOX



BOX AS ERECTED

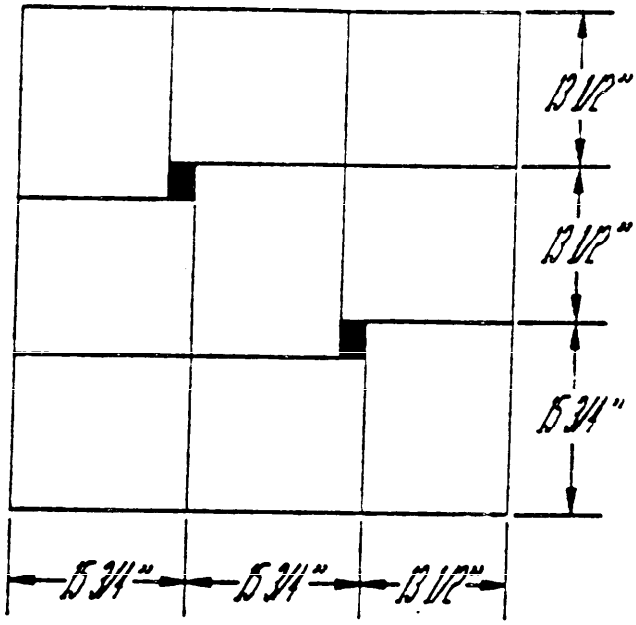
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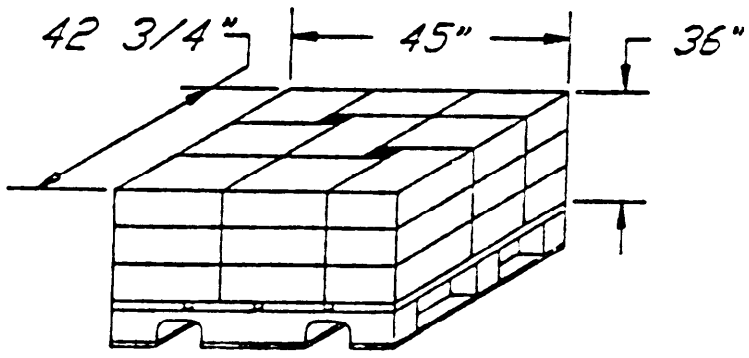
FIGURE 5. ASSEMBLY OF FILLED PAPERBOARD BOX INTO SHIPPING CONTAINER



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FIGURE 6. PALLETIZED UNIT LOAD
(DIMENSIONS APPROXIMATE)





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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-R-44386(GL)	RATION LIGHTWEIGHT, 30-DAY, ASSEMBLY OF

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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